



Feature Roadmap & Future Development

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1. Overview

This document provides a complete picture of the YT Transcriber product across three dimensions: what is **currently live** in the MVP, what has been **planned** as the next phases of development, and **recommended future features** that would strengthen the product, improve retention, and open new revenue opportunities.

Features are grouped into four release tiers:

Label	Meaning
✓ Live	Already built and working in the current MVP.
Phase 1	Next immediate build — Clerk auth, billing, and subscription tiers.
Phase 2	Collections, sharing, and team collaboration features.
Phase 3	AI-powered features, automation, and advanced transcript tools.
Future	Longer-term ideas for v2+ — high value but not immediately required.

2. Currently Live — MVP Feature Set

The following features are fully built and working in the current Docker-based Flask application. This is a solid, clean MVP with no outstanding TODOs or partial implementations.

Feature	Detail
YouTube URL submission	Accepts youtube.com,youtu.be, embed/, and Shorts URLs. Extracts video ID via regex. Rejects invalid URLs gracefully with an error message.
Background processing	Transcription runs in a background thread. Client polls /api/status every 2 seconds and auto-redirects when complete. Shows 'Still processing' banner during processing.
Video metadata fetch	Scrapes YouTube HTML to extract video title, description, and thumbnail. Falls back to video ID as title if metadata is unavailable.
Transcript grouping	Raw caption snippets are grouped into proper sentences using punctuation detection (full stop, exclamation mark, question mark). Each sentence stores its start timestamp.
Timestamped transcript viewer	Each sentence is displayed with a clickable timestamp button. Clicking the timestamp seeks the embedded YouTube player to that exact position via the YouTube postMessage API.
Embedded YouTube player	YouTube iframe embedded on the video detail page. Syncs with timestamp buttons in the transcript panel for seamless navigation.
Transcript search	Real-time keyword filter in the transcript panel. Non-matching lines are hidden instantly as the user types. No page reload required.
URL detection & screenshots	Regex extracts all HTTP/HTTPS URLs mentioned in the transcript. Playwright captures 1280×900px PNG screenshots of each URL. Failures are handled gracefully (URL stored, screenshot skipped).
Links & screenshots panel	Dedicated panel showing all extracted URLs with their timestamps, clickable links, and screenshot thumbnails. Timestamps also seek the YouTube player.
Notes panel	Per-video textarea for user notes. Saved via /api/notes POST. Shows a brief 'Saved ✓' confirmation. Notes persist across sessions in the server-side JSON store.
ZIP export	Downloads a ZIP containing: transcript PDF (with screenshots embedded), notes.txt, links.txt, and a screenshots/ folder with all captured PNGs.
5 colour themes	Dark, Light, Ocean, Forest, and Sunset themes with full CSS variable coverage. Selected theme persists in localStorage across sessions.
Video library (home page)	Grid of all processed videos with thumbnails, titles, and processing dates. Sorted newest first. Status badges for in-progress or failed videos.
Duplicate detection	If a URL has already been processed, the app redirects immediately to the existing result page without re-processing.

Feature	Detail
Responsive layout	Two-column layout on desktop (>900px), single column on mobile. Sticky topbar. Scrollable transcript panel with fixed height.
JSON storage layer	All data stored as JSON files in output/{video_id}/. Storage module is designed to be swapped for a database (Supabase, PostgreSQL) without changes to other modules.
Docker deployment	Fully containerised via Docker and docker-compose. Runs on port 5000.

3. Phase 1 — Authentication & Subscription Billing

Phase 1 transforms the MVP into a commercial SaaS product. It introduces user accounts, a free trial, and paid subscription tiers. All auth and billing is handled via **Clerk** (authentication + billing UI) and **Stripe** (payment processing).

Feature	Description	Priority
Clerk authentication	Email/password and social login (Google, GitHub). Clerk handles session management, JWTs, and password reset flows. Flask middleware validates the Clerk session token on protected routes.	Critical
User accounts	Each user has their own video library. Videos are scoped to the authenticated user — no user can see another's transcripts. Replaces the current shared JSON store.	Critical
Free trial (3 videos)	New users get 3 free transcriptions with full features. Card required upfront. Trial is one-time per account. After 3 videos, user must subscribe to continue.	Critical
Subscription tiers	Three paid tiers: Creator (£7/mo, 15 videos), Studio (£19/mo, 60 videos), Enterprise (£45/mo, unlimited). Managed via Clerk Billing + Stripe. Tier enforced server-side.	Critical
Feature gating by plan	Creator tier: core transcript + export only (no URL screenshots in ZIP, no transcript search). Studio: all current features. Enterprise: all features + future team tools.	Critical
Credit/quota tracking	Server tracks how many videos each user has processed this billing period. Shows remaining credits on the dashboard. Resets monthly on billing date.	High
Billing portal	Clerk's built-in billing portal lets users upgrade, downgrade, and cancel their subscription without contacting support. Accessible from account settings.	High
Upgrade prompts	When a user hits their monthly limit or tries to access a gated feature, show a contextual upgrade prompt rather than a generic error.	High
Account settings page	User can view their current plan, usage this period, billing history, and update their email or password. Links to Clerk billing portal.	Medium
Database migration	Replace JSON file storage with a proper database (PostgreSQL via Supabase or Railway). Required for multi-user isolation, query performance, and backup reliability.	Critical

4. Phase 2 — Collections, Sharing & Collaboration

Phase 2 focuses on organisation and discoverability — helping users manage a growing library of transcripts, share content with others, and begin laying the groundwork for team use cases.

Feature	Description	Tier
Collections / folders	Users can create named collections (e.g. 'Research', 'Podcasts', 'Client Videos') and assign videos to them. Collections appear in the sidebar. Videos can belong to multiple collections.	Creator+
Video tagging	Add freeform tags to videos (e.g. '#marketing', '#interview'). Filter the library by tag. Tags are searchable across the whole library.	Creator+
Library search	Global search across all video titles, descriptions, and transcript text. Returns matching videos with a snippet of the matching sentence highlighted.	Studio+
Share links	Generate a public read-only share link for any transcript. Recipient can view the transcript, timestamps, and links panel — but not notes. Links can be revoked.	Studio+
Share link expiry	Optional expiry on share links (24 hours, 7 days, 30 days, never). Expired links show a friendly 'This link has expired' page.	Studio+
Video deletion	Users can delete videos from their library. Removes all associated files (screenshots, JSON). Soft-delete with 30-day recovery window before permanent removal.	All
Bulk actions	Select multiple videos on the home page. Bulk delete, bulk add to collection, or bulk export as a multi-video ZIP.	Studio+
Video renaming	Allow users to override the auto-fetched video title with a custom name in their library. Useful when YouTube titles are vague.	All
Team workspaces	Enterprise users can invite team members to a shared workspace. All team members can view and search the shared video library. Roles: Owner, Editor, Viewer.	Enterprise
Workspace activity feed	Shows recent activity in a team workspace — who processed what, when. Useful for research teams and content agencies.	Enterprise

5. Phase 3 — AI Features & Automation

Phase 3 introduces AI-powered features using the Claude API (Haiku model for cost efficiency) and automation tools that allow the product to run without the user needing to manually submit each video.

Feature	Description	Model / Cost Est.
AI chapter markers	Claude analyses the full transcript and generates a set of named chapter markers with timestamps (e.g. '0:00 — Introduction', '4:32 — Key Argument'). Displayed above the transcript panel. Clickable — seeks the player.	Haiku ~£0.01/use
AI summary	One-paragraph summary of the video generated from the transcript. Appears at the top of the video detail page. Toggle to show/hide. Included in the ZIP export.	Haiku ~£0.005/use
Key quotes extraction	Claude identifies the 5–10 most quotable or important sentences from the transcript and highlights them in the transcript viewer. Useful for journalists and researchers.	Haiku ~£0.008/use
Action items extraction	For instructional or meeting-style videos, Claude extracts a list of action items or takeaways from the transcript. Shown in a dedicated panel.	Haiku ~£0.005/use
Transcript correction	Inline editor allowing users to fix transcript errors (typos, misheard words). Changes saved back to the stored transcript. A 'corrected' badge shows on the video card.	No AI — user edits
Auto-translation	Translate the transcript into another language using Claude. Supports major languages. Translated transcript shown alongside the original with toggle. Included in export.	Haiku ~£0.02/use
Scheduled transcription — channel	User provides a YouTube channel URL. The app polls daily for new uploads and auto-processes them. New transcripts appear in the library automatically.	Background worker
Scheduled transcription — playlist	User provides a playlist URL. All current and future videos in the playlist are automatically transcribed as they are added.	Background worker
Email digest	Weekly email showing new transcripts processed from watched channels/playlists, with links to view each one. Sent via Brevo.	Brevo free tier
Webhook notifications	When a new scheduled transcription completes, fire a webhook to a user-specified URL (e.g. n8n, Zapier, Slack). Useful for power users integrating into workflows.	Studio+ / Enterprise

6. Future Ideas — v2 and Beyond

The following features are not planned for the immediate roadmap but represent high-value opportunities for future versions. They are ranked roughly by user impact and development effort.

Product Expansion

Feature	Why It's Valuable	Effort
Podcast / audio file support	Extends YT Transcriber beyond YouTube to any audio or video file. Major market expansion — podcasters, journalists recording interviews, corporate meetings.	High
Browser extension	One-click transcription from the YouTube page itself. No need to copy/paste the URL. Strong acquisition channel — discoverable in the Chrome Web Store.	Medium
Chrome extension with overlay	Shows transcript as a real-time overlay on the YouTube page. Power users can read along while watching without switching tabs.	High
Mobile app (iOS / Android)	Native app for consuming transcripts on the go. Share Sheet integration — share a YouTube link from the iOS YouTube app directly to YT Transcriber.	Very High
Bulk URL import	Paste a list of YouTube URLs (or a channel/playlist) and process them all in one go. Results available when batch is complete.	Low
Transcript comparison	Side-by-side comparison of two transcripts — useful for researchers comparing two interviews or lectures on the same topic.	Medium
Custom branding on exports	Enterprise users can add their own logo and brand colours to exported PDFs and Word docs. White-label option for agencies.	Low
Public profile / portfolio	Optional public page showing a user's published transcripts. Good for researchers who want to share curated video content publicly.	Medium

AI & Intelligence

Feature	Why It's Valuable	Effort
Semantic transcript search	Search by meaning rather than exact keywords — e.g. 'moments where they discuss pricing' surfaces relevant sections even if the word 'pricing' is not used. Powered by embeddings (Claude or OpenAI).	High
Cross-video question answering	Ask a question across your entire library — 'What did these 10 speakers say about AI regulation?' — and get a synthesised answer with source citations.	High
Speaker diarisation	Identify and label different speakers in the transcript (Speaker 1, Speaker 2, etc.). Essential for interviews and panel discussions.	High

Feature	Why It's Valuable	Effort
Sentiment analysis	Highlight sections of the transcript by sentiment (positive, neutral, negative). Useful for brand monitoring and competitor research.	Medium
Clip generation suggestions	Claude identifies the 3–5 most shareable moments from the transcript and flags them as clip suggestions with timestamps — ideal for content creators.	Medium
Auto-tagging	Claude automatically suggests tags for each video based on transcript content. Saves manual tagging and improves library organisation.	Low
Reading difficulty score	Rate how technical or accessible the content is. Useful for educators and researchers assessing content suitability.	Low

Export & Integrations

Feature	Why It's Valuable	Effort
Notion integration	Export any transcript directly to a Notion page. One of the most-requested features for knowledge workers who use Notion as their second brain.	Medium
Obsidian / Markdown export	Export transcript as a clean Markdown file with YAML frontmatter (title, date, URL). Zero-friction for Obsidian, Logseq, and Bear users.	Low
Google Docs export	Push a transcript to a new Google Doc in the user's Drive. Formatted with headings, timestamps, and a summary section.	Medium
Subtitle / SRT file export	Export the transcript as a .srt subtitle file. Useful for creators who want to add captions to re-uploaded or edited versions of the video.	Low
Zapier / Make integration	Trigger a Zapier or Make (Integromat) workflow when a new transcription completes. Opens YT Transcriber to hundreds of downstream automations.	Medium
Slack integration	Post a transcript summary and link to a Slack channel when a new video is processed. Especially useful for team workspaces.	Low
RSS feed per channel	Subscribe to a watched YouTube channel via RSS. New transcripts appear in the user's RSS reader automatically.	Low

7. Full Feature Status Summary

A consolidated view of every feature across all phases for quick reference.

Feature	Phase	Tier
YouTube URL submission	✓ Live	All
Background processing	✓ Live	All
Video metadata fetch	✓ Live	All
Transcript grouping	✓ Live	All
Timestamped transcript viewer	✓ Live	All
Embedded YouTube player	✓ Live	All
Real-time transcript search	✓ Live	Studio+
URL detection & screenshots	✓ Live	Studio+
Links & screenshots panel	✓ Live	Studio+
Notes panel	✓ Live	All
ZIP export	✓ Live	All
5 colour themes	✓ Live	All
Video library / home page	✓ Live	All
Duplicate detection	✓ Live	All
Responsive layout	✓ Live	All
Clerk authentication	Phase 1	All
User accounts & isolation	Phase 1	All
Free trial (3 videos)	Phase 1	All
Subscription tiers	Phase 1	All
Feature gating by plan	Phase 1	All
Credit / quota tracking	Phase 1	All
Billing portal (Clerk)	Phase 1	All
Upgrade prompts	Phase 1	All
Account settings page	Phase 1	All
Database migration (PostgreSQL)	Phase 1	All
Collections / folders	Phase 2	Creator+

Feature	Phase	Tier
Video tagging	Phase 2	Creator+
Library search	Phase 2	Studio+
Share links	Phase 2	Studio+
Share link expiry	Phase 2	Studio+
Video deletion	Phase 2	All
Bulk actions	Phase 2	Studio+
Video renaming	Phase 2	All
Team workspaces	Phase 2	Enterprise
Workspace activity feed	Phase 2	Enterprise
AI chapter markers	Phase 3	Studio+
AI summary	Phase 3	Studio+
Key quotes extraction	Phase 3	Studio+
Action items extraction	Phase 3	Studio+
Transcript correction	Phase 3	All
Auto-translation	Phase 3	Studio+
Scheduled transcription — channel	Phase 3	Studio+
Scheduled transcription — playlist	Phase 3	Studio+
Email digest	Phase 3	All
Webhook notifications	Phase 3	Studio+
Podcast / audio file support	Future	TBD
Browser extension	Future	All
Mobile app	Future	TBD
Bulk URL import	Future	Studio+
Semantic transcript search	Future	Studio+
Cross-video question answering	Future	Studio+
Speaker diarisation	Future	Studio+
Notion integration	Future	All
Obsidian / Markdown export	Future	All

Feature	Phase	Tier
Google Docs export	Future	All
SRT subtitle export	Future	All
Zapier / Make integration	Future	Studio+
Clip generation suggestions	Future	Studio+
Custom branding on exports	Future	Enterprise

8. Recommended Build Order

The following sequence is recommended to maximise value delivered at each step while minimising rework. Each milestone produces a shippable, monetisable product.

Milestone	Phase	Scope & Goal
M1 — Auth & Free Trial	Phase 1	Clerk auth, user accounts, database migration. Free trial (3 videos). Gate features by plan. This is the minimum needed to charge money.
M2 — Billing & Tiers	Phase 1	Stripe via Clerk. Creator, Studio, Enterprise tiers. Billing portal, upgrade prompts, credit tracking. Soft launch to first paying users.
M3 — Organisation	Phase 2	Collections, tagging, video deletion, renaming. Core library management. Low effort, high user satisfaction impact.
M4 — Sharing	Phase 2	Share links with optional expiry. Public read-only view. Viral acquisition loop — shared transcripts drive new signups.
M5 — AI Features	Phase 3	AI chapter markers, summary, key quotes. These are clear upgrade incentives for Creator → Studio. Use Claude Haiku to keep costs low.
M6 — Transcript Tools	Phase 3	Transcript correction, auto-translation. High value for researchers and international users. Deepens Studio/Enterprise stickiness.
M7 — Automation	Phase 3	Scheduled channel/playlist transcription, email digest, webhooks. Transitions YT Transcriber from a tool to a platform.
M8 — Team Features	Phase 2/3	Team workspaces, shared libraries, activity feed. Unlocks B2B expansion and justifies Enterprise pricing.
M9 — Integrations	Future	Notion, Google Docs, Obsidian, Zapier. Embeds YT Transcriber into existing user workflows. Significant retention driver.
M10 — Platform Expansion	Future	Browser extension, podcast/audio support, mobile app. Each opens a new acquisition channel and a new market segment.

Note: Milestones M1–M2 are revenue-critical and should be completed before any Phase 2 or Phase 3 work begins. The product cannot scale commercially without a working auth and billing system.